

Sidewalk Stories LA — Partnership Outline for Jason Clement

Three role options to discuss on the call. These are conversation starters, not final offers.

Context for the discussion

Jason built a sidewalk photo app for a political campaign. The app lets users photograph sidewalk damage and capture geolocation automatically. For Sidewalk Stories LA, this same infrastructure could power: resident submissions, community voting, winner notification, and public before/after documentation.

Because this is a nonprofit, there is no equity, profit share, or ownership stake. Jason's compensation comes in the form of role, credit, governance influence, and either (a) app licensing revenue, (b) deferred contractor fees, or (c) volunteer contribution with tax documentation.

Option 1: Founding Board Member + Tech Lead

Role: Jason sits on the founding Board of Directors as the technology and platform director.

What he does: - Own the app roadmap, hosting, maintenance, and security - Advise on digital strategy and data privacy - Vote on major organizational decisions as a director - Contribute the existing app codebase under a license agreement (nonprofit owns or leases the app)

What he gets: - Founding Board Member title and public credit - Governance voice equal to other directors (vote on budget, hiring, strategic direction) - No compensation for board service (IRS rules: uncompensated or recused compensation) - App licensing agreement: nonprofit pays a modest annual license fee (\$2,400/year = \$200/month, or deferred until grant funding closes)

IP arrangement: - Jason retains ownership of the original app IP - Nonprofit receives a perpetual, royalty-free license to use, modify, and operate the app for the Sidewalk Stories LA program - Any nonprofit-specific modifications or new features built for Sidewalk Stories LA become joint IP or nonprofit-owned, depending on negotiation

Pros: Strong governance role, public credibility, app stays in his portfolio. **Cons:** No direct compensation until nonprofit revenue allows contractor fees; fiduciary duties as a director.

Option 2: Volunteer Tech Advisor + App License

Role: Jason is not a board member but serves as a volunteer technology advisor.

What he does: - Advise on app architecture, hosting, and feature priorities - Maintain the app on a volunteer or minimal-hours basis - No governance authority; advises at the pleasure of the board

What he gets: - Technology Advisor title and public credit - Flexible time commitment (no formal hours) - App licensing agreement: nonprofit pays an annual license fee only if and when it has grant revenue to cover it - Potential to transition to a paid contractor role in Year 2 if the program scales

IP arrangement: - Same as Option 1: Jason retains original app IP; nonprofit gets a license - Any Sidewalk Stories LA-specific work product is owned by the nonprofit

Pros: Low commitment, no fiduciary liability, keeps optionality open. **Cons:** No governance voice, less public profile, deferred or minimal compensation.

Option 3: Co-Founder Equivalent (nonprofit framing)

Role: Jason is positioned as a co-founder alongside Trevor, with a permanent seat on the board and a defined program area.

What he does: - Equal public billing as co-founder - Board seat with voting rights - Defined role: "Co-Founder and Chief Technology Officer" (CTO is a staff title; in a nonprofit with no staff, this is an honorary/functional title) - Responsible for all technology: app, website, data, integrations - Expected time commitment: 5 to 10 hours/week in Year 1

What he gets: - Co-Founder title on all materials - Board seat with equal governance weight - App contributed to the nonprofit under a joint IP agreement (nonprofit and Jason co-own the Sidewalk Stories LA instance; Jason retains the original campaign version) - Deferred compensation: if the nonprofit hires staff in Year 2, Jason is first in line for a paid CTO or Technology Director role - Reimbursement for hosting and infrastructure costs

IP arrangement: - The Sidewalk Stories LA app (the campaign app modified for this use case) is jointly owned by the nonprofit and Jason - Either party can use it for the nonprofit mission without additional permission - Jason retains the right to use the original unmodified codebase for other projects

Pros: Maximum recognition, equal partnership feel, strong incentive to build. **Cons:** Highest time commitment, fiduciary duties, co-ownership may complicate future grant reporting if IP ownership is questioned.

Recommended approach

Start with Option 1 (Founding Board Member + Tech Lead). It gives Jason real governance and credit without overpromising on compensation or co-ownership. If the conversation goes well and he wants more, you can move toward Option 3. If he is hesitant about time, fall back to Option 2.

Questions to ask Jason on the call

1. How much time can you realistically commit in Year 1? (Be honest: this is a nights and weekends startup.)
2. Do you want to be on the board with voting rights, or advise from the sidelines?

3. What is your preference on the app IP: license it to the nonprofit, or co-own the modified version?
 4. Are you comfortable with no cash compensation in Year 1, or do you need a small deferred stipend?
 5. Can you share the existing app codebase or a demo so we can assess what needs to change?
 6. What does the app currently cost to host per month? (The model budgets \$200/month; confirm this is realistic.)
 7. Do you want to be publicly credited as a co-founder, or is Tech Lead sufficient?
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What to bring to the call

- Sidewalk_Stories_LA_Grant_Concept.docx (the one-pager)
- Sidewalk_Mosaic_Nonprofit_Financial_Model.xlsx (the current model, with notes that it is being revised)
- This Partnership Outline (print or share screen)
- A blank sheet for Jason's answers to the seven questions above